

FREE READER BONUS

The Flavor *Matrix*

Mix and match fats, flavors, and finishing touches to develop your own candle combinations.

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Five steps, and how much of each flavor to use as the star or as a friend.

02 **Savory Matrix** p. 4
Garlic, chili, citrus, cheese and more, with the herbs and spices that love them.

03 **Sweet & Chocolate Matrix** p. 5
Honey, maple, vanilla, chocolate and more, with their best friends.

04 **Try It Small** p. 6
Test three ideas from one cup of butter and keep notes on the winners.



A COMPANION TO

The Edible Candles Cookbook

Pick a star, follow its row, and build a candle that's all your own.

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Build Your Candle

Every candle is a fat, a star, one or two friends, and a finishing touch. Here's how to put yours together.

1 Pick your fat

1 cup, softened: unsalted butter, ghee, plant-based butter, bacon fat, or refined coconut oil, cup for cup. **Cheese:** ¾ cup (170 g) butter + 2 oz (57 g) cheese. **Chocolate:** ¾ cup (170 g) butter + 4 oz (113 g) chocolate.

2 Pick your star

The flavor people notice first. Find it in the left column of the **Savory** (p. 4) or **Sweet & Chocolate** (p. 5) matrix.

3 Follow its row and pick a friend

Every ● in your star's row is a friend that goes with it. Choose one or two friends, never more.

4 Add a finishing touch

On the sides, never on top: flaky salt, pressed herb leaves, a ring of zest, chopped nuts, whole dried berries, a dusting of spice.

5 Measure, taste, then follow The Method

Start with the amounts on the next page, taste, and adjust. Star and friends **add up**: together they stay within the firm limits below. Then follow The Method from Step 1 to 7, with a primed wick. New idea? Try it small first (p. 6).

Taste as you go

Here's the best part: you can taste a candle before you make it. Beat in the smaller amount, spread a little of the soft butter on bread, and add more a pinch at a time until you love it.

Firm limits: they keep the flame happy

- Sticky sweets (honey, maple, molasses, purées): about 2 tbsp in all, star and friends together.
- Fresh herbs: about 2 tbsp in all, chopped and patted dry.
- Fruit: freeze-dried only, about ¼ cup crushed to a powder.
- Citrus: zest only, never juice. Extracts, never liquor.
- Cheese: about 1 part to 3 parts butter by weight, with the Cheese Wick.
- Chocolate: ¾ cup (170 g) butter + 4 oz (113 g) chocolate.
- Garlic or herbs in oil: fridge only, up to 4 days.
- Cheese, bacon, or fresh herbs: serve within 2 hours, then refrigerate.

How Much of Each

Per 1 cup of fat, for one star and one or two friends. Start here, taste, and adjust: "taste" means start with a pinch and add a little at a time. Stay within the firm limits on page 2.

FLAVOR	AS THE STAR	AS A FRIEND
Ground spices cinnamon, paprika, chipotle or chili powder, cumin, ginger, cardamom, nutmeg	1 tsp	¼ tsp cayenne, cloves: a pinch
Spice blends pie spice, chai, curry, Cajun	1½ tsp	1 tsp
Chili crisp, hot sauce	1½ to 2 tbsp	taste
Jalapeño	—	1, seeded and minced
Garlic	2 cloves, grated roasted: up to 10	1 clove or ¼ tsp powder
Fresh herbs thyme, rosemary, sage, basil, parsley, chives, dill, tarragon, cilantro	2 tbsp	1 tsp
Dried herbs oregano, Italian seasoning, lavender	—	½ to 1 tsp
Rose	—	½ tsp rose water or 1 tsp dried petals
Citrus zest	Zest of 1 lemon or 2 limes	½ to 1 tsp
Honey, maple, molasses	2 tbsp	1 tbsp
Brown sugar	2 to 3 tbsp	1 tbsp
Vanilla	Seeds of 1 bean or 1 tsp paste	½ tsp extract
Espresso powder, coffee	2 tsp espresso powder	taste
Pumpkin, apple butter	2 tbsp pumpkin purée blotted dry	—
Freeze-dried berries	¼ cup, crushed to a powder	2 to 3 tbsp
Nuts, dried fruit	⅓ to ½ cup, chopped	2 to 3 tbsp
Bacon	2 to 4 slices, crumbled	2 slices
Truffle	1 tsp truffle salt + ½ tsp truffle oil	taste
Porcini powder	taste	taste
Black or pink pepper	—	¼ tsp
Flaky salt	—	a pinch to ½ tsp
Extracts bourbon, rum, maple	—	¼ to ½ tsp
Chocolate	4 oz with ¾ cup butter	taste
Cheese feta, goat, cheddar, blue	2 to 3 oz with ¾ cup butter ricotta: ¼ cup, drained	—
Parmesan, Pecorino	½ to ¾ cup, grated	¼ cup
Brie in its rind	About half and half with butter	—

STEPS 2 & 3

Savory Matrix

Find your star on the left, then read across its row for its friends.

● they go well together — same flavor empty: no pairing on record yet

	Thyme	Rosemary	Sage	Oregano	Basil	Parsley	Chives	Dill	Tarragon	Cilantro	Garlic	Black pepper	Paprika & chili	Citrus zest	Honey & maple
Garlic	●	●		●	●	●	●		●	●	—	●	●	●	
Smoked paprika	●					●	●			●	●	●	—	●	●
Chili & chipotle		●					●			●	●		●	●	●
Cumin & curry										●	●		●	●	●
Lemon	●	●				●	●	●	●		●	●	●	—	●
Lime										●	●		●	—	
Orange		●							●					—	●
Mushroom & truffle		●	●								●	●			
Bacon	●						●					●	●		●
Parmesan & Pecorino	●	●		●							●	●		●	
Cheddar	●	●	●				●			●	●	●	●		●
Goat cheese & feta	●				●			●			●	●		●	●
Blue cheese	●						●					●			
Brie	●	●			●	●	●		●			●		●	
Ricotta	●				●							●		●	

Cheese stars: about 1 part cheese to 3 parts butter by weight, e.g. ¾ cup (170 g) butter + 2 oz (57 g) cheese, always with the Cheese Wick. Brie in its rind: about half and half.

STEPS 2 & 3

Sweet & Chocolate Matrix

Find your star on the left, then read across its row for its friends.

● they go well together — same flavor empty: no pairing on record yet

	Cinnamon	Nutmeg	Ginger	Cloves	Cardamom	Vanilla	Black & pink pepper	Citrus zest	Lavender & rose	Nuts	Dried fruit	Coffee	Chocolate	Thyme, rosemary & sage	Flaky salt
Honey	●		●	●		●		●	●		●			●	●
Maple	●	●	●	●	●	●	●	●	●	●	●		●	●	●
Brown sugar & molasses	●	●	●	●		●		●		●		●			●
Vanilla	●	●		●	●	—	●	●	●		●	●	●		
Orange	●		●	●	●	●		—			●		●	●	●
Lemon	●				●	●	●	—			●			●	●
Dark chocolate	●	●	●	●	●	●		●		●	●	●	—		●
Milk chocolate	●		●	●	●	●				●			—		●
White chocolate	●		●	●	●		●		●	●	●		—		
Coffee & espresso	●					●						—	●		
Berries			●		●	●	●	●	●		—		●	●	●
Pumpkin	●	●				●							●	●	
Apple	●	●													

Chocolate stars: ¾ cup (170 g) butter + 4 oz (113 g) chocolate, cooled until barely warm before you beat it in.

YOUR TURN

Try It Small

Split one cup of butter into three small 4 oz paper cups and try a different idea in each.

- Follow The Method exactly as you would for any recipe, with a primed wick in each cup.
- Label the cups, so you know which is which once they're out of the fridge.
- Light them side by side, taste, and compare. If something doesn't go as planned, the Fix-It Guide is there to help.

Cup 1

FAT

STAR

FRIEND

FINISHING TOUCH

HOW IT LIT

HOW IT TASTED

☐ Make it again
☐ Tweak it
☐ Skip it

Cup 2

FAT

STAR

FRIEND

FINISHING TOUCH

HOW IT LIT

HOW IT TASTED

☐ Make it again
☐ Tweak it
☐ Skip it

Cup 3

FAT

STAR

FRIEND

FINISHING TOUCH

HOW IT LIT

HOW IT TASTED

☐ Make it again
☐ Tweak it
☐ Skip it

Found a winner?
Write it up on one of your My Candle Cards, so the recipe is ready for your next gathering.

These are guidelines for your own experiments, not tested recipes. Follow the safety rules in The Edible Candles Cookbook: use only food-safe wicks, never leave a lit candle unattended, keep it away from anything flammable, and check every ingredient for allergens. The author and publisher are not liable for any damage or injury arising from the use of this guide.